International Payment Guideline

Applicable Centres: All BAPS centres

Departments Involved: All departments except Shayona

Work Closely with: National Accounts Team, Local Accounts Team, Local Fund-Raising Team

Version Control

Version	Date	Effective Date	Author / Owner	Approved by	Summary of Changes
1**.0**	22/12/2025		National Accounts Team	Pujya Paramchintan Swami	Initial Draft

1. Purpose of the Role

The National Dharmada Lead is responsible for overseeing, coordinating, and maintaining all Dharmado (Lakhani)–related activities across Australia. This role ensures that donor commitments are accurately recorded, processed, and maintained, while upholding the highest standards of governance, transparency, and donor care.

The position acts as the central point of coordination between donors, centre Dharmada leads, the National Accounts Team, and Pujya Kothari Sant.

2. Dharmado (lakhani)

Dharmado is voluntary donations made by devotees to support mandir construction and maintenance, community welfare initiatives, religious and cultural activities and ongoing operational needs of BAPS. This does not cover project-based fund raising initiatives.

Donations may be one-off or recurring, and can be contributed via Cash, EFT, or Direct Debit.

3. Dharmado Setup

3.1 **Coordination of Donor Meetings**

- Work with centre Dharmada leads to schedule donor meetings with Pujya Kothari Sant or Pujya Local Vicharan Sant.
- Centre Dharmada leads to prepare a donor list for Pujya Swami containing following details:
    - Donor Name
    - Current Seva Amount
    - New Seva Amount
    - Notes or special instructions
- Ensure centre Dharmada leads keep Direct Debit forms (Bank & Credit Card) readily available to be filled by donor after meeting with Pujya Swami if the donor is new or do not have existing direct debit setup.

3.2 **Processing Changes to Seva Amounts**

For donors changing their seva amount:

- Centre Dharmada lead emails central.accounts01@au.baps.org with:
    - Subject: Request of Change in Direct Debit for XXXX (Donor ID)
    - Current Amount
    - New Amount
    - Effective Date

    - Purpose of Donation
    - Updated bank details (if applicable)
    - CC: fundraising@au.baps.org and the donor
- Forward completed direct debit forms to the same recipients.

3.3 **Direct Debit Expiry Tracking**

- Maintain a record of expiry dates for all donor cards.
- **Do NOT store card numbers or sensitive details.**
- Contact donors at least 2 weeks before expiry to update their details.

3.4 **Donor Acknowledgement**

National Dharmada Lead to send Thank you email to donor as an acknowledgement and appropriation for their commitment.

4. Direct Debit Maintenance

- Dharmada Lead will be a point of contact for any change in the direct debits – i.e. Change in bank detail, Credit Card details, frequency, amount, cancellation, suspensions or resumption.
- All change requests must be received in writing.
- If change requests received via text or WhatsApp (except cancellations or suspension), email the donor attaching their original message for audit trail.
- National Dharmada Lead to speak to donor for the change request.
- National Accounts Team to notify National Dharmada Lead for any change request received by donor.
- National Accounts Team to:
    - print all communication related to changes and store with the original Direct Debit form.
    - Action the request within 24 hours.
    - Confirm completion of action with both donor and National Dharmada Lead
- For those whose credit card / debit card is being expired in near future, National Dharmada Lead to contact donor to update their details at least 2 weeks prior to their direct debit.
- For any dishonoured direct debits, promptly inform Dharmada Lead for follow-up and resolution with 24 hours.
- Notify National Accounts team to reattempt the transaction if confirmed by the donor
- Maintain an up-to-date Yajman record based on the defined threshold.
- National Dharmada Lead to maintain a record of change request including dishonoured direct debits.

5. Reporting

- Prepare a centre-wise and donor-wise Dharmado report every month.
- Prepare change request and dishonoured direct debit report every month.
- Submit the reports to Pujya Kothari Sant by the 10th of each month.
- Ensure reports are accurate, complete, and reflect all changes processed during the month.

6. Collaboration

- Work closely with:
  - Centre Dharmada Leads
  - National Accounts Team
  - Pujya Kothari Swami
- Ensure all Dharmado processes follow internal policies, compliance requirements, and audit standards.
- Maintain confidentiality and integrity in handling donor information.